Term Plan 2026

Grade 5 · Mathematics · South Africa · Intermediate Phase

This plan tells the class teacher what mathematics lessons cover in each of the four terms. It is written week by week in plain paragraphs. Each paragraph names the focus of the weeks and what learners do. Number work, shapes, measurement and data are taught together, so one week often touches more than one of them.

Learners have six mathematics lessons a week. Four are for number work, one is for shape and measurement, and one is for mental mathematics and games. Teachers may swap lessons within a week, but the order of the focus topics stays the same.

A topic that appears in two terms is taught again on purpose, at a deeper level the second time. A topic that belongs to a different grade is mentioned only so that teachers know it is not part of this year.

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Term 1

Weeks 1 and 2. The focus is whole numbers up to 1 000 000. Learners read, write and order large numbers, use place value to show a number in expanded form, and round numbers to the nearest ten, hundred and thousand.

Weeks 3 and 4. The focus is addition and subtraction of larger numbers. Learners add and subtract numbers with up to six digits using a written method, check answers by estimating first, and solve word problems about distances and prices.

Weeks 5 and 6. The focus is multiplication and division of whole numbers. Learners multiply by one-digit and two-digit numbers, divide by one-digit numbers with remainders, and use arrays to explain what they are doing.

Weeks 7 and 8. The focus is multiples and factors. Learners list the multiples of a number, find all the factors of numbers up to 100, and use a hundred square to spot patterns in multiples.

Weeks 9 and 10. The focus is time. Learners read analogue and digital clocks, change between hours, minutes and seconds, read a calendar and work out how long an event lasted.

Term 2

Weeks 1 to 3. The focus is common fractions. Learners name and write fractions of a whole and of a set, show them on fraction strips and number lines, and compare fractions that have the same bottom number.

Weeks 4 and 5. The focus is equivalent fractions. Learners fold paper and use fraction walls to find fractions that are equal, such as one half and two quarters, and write a fraction in its simplest form.

Weeks 6 to 9. The focus is perimeter and area. Learners measure the distance around rectangles and squares with a ruler, count square units to find area, and work out how the perimeter changes when the sides change.

Term 3

Weeks 1 and 2. The focus is perimeter and area again. Learners find the perimeter and area of shapes made from two rectangles and solve word problems about fences and floor tiles. This builds on the work of Term 2.

Weeks 3 to 5. The focus is decimal fractions. Learners write tenths and hundredths as decimals, show them on a number line and in a place value chart, and compare and order decimals with up to two places.

Weeks 6 and 7. The focus is two-dimensional shapes and three-dimensional objects. Learners sort shapes by their sides and corners, name cubes, prisms and pyramids, and count their faces, edges and corners.

Weeks 8 to 10. The focus is capacity and mass. Learners measure with measuring jugs and kitchen scales, change between millilitres and litres and between grams and kilograms, and solve word problems about recipes.

Term 4

Weeks 1 to 3. The focus is number patterns and number sentences. Learners extend and describe patterns of numbers and shapes, find the rule, and write number sentences with a missing number.

Weeks 4 and 5. The focus is money and simple budgets. Learners add and subtract amounts of money, work out change, and plan a small budget for a class party. Percentages is a Grade 7 topic and is not taught this year, so learners should not be asked to work with percentages.

Weeks 6 and 7. The focus is data handling. Learners collect data with a tally chart, show it in a bar graph and a pictograph, and answer questions about what the graph tells them.

Week 8. The focus is position and movement. Learners read a simple map with a grid, say where things are using words such as left, right, north and south, and give directions from one place to another.

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